

Recorded by **BILLY JOEL**

# The Longest Time

For SATB\* a cappella

Duration: ca. 3:30

Arranged by  
**KIRBY SHAW**

Words and Music by  
**BILLY JOEL**

Opt. finger snaps

Doo-wop (♩ = ca. 84) *mf* *sim.*

Tenor Solo

Woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long<sup>†</sup>- est

Soprano Alto

Woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long<sup>†</sup>- est

Tenor Bass

*mf* Bm bm bm, woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long<sup>†</sup>- est, for the long - est

Piano (for rehearsal only)

Doo-wop (♩ = ca. 84) *mf*

time. Woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long - est.

time. Woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long - est.

time. Woh, \_\_\_\_\_ for the long - est, for the long - est.

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\* Available separately:  
SATB, SAB, SSA

† when singing "Long", go immediately to "ng"

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5

8

1. If you said good - bye to me to - night,  
2. Once I thought my in - no - cense was gone.

Oo, \_\_\_\_\_ oo, \_\_\_\_\_

Unis.

5

8

there would still be mu - sic left to write.  
Now I know that hap - pi - ness goes on.

oo. \_\_\_\_\_ Ah, \_\_\_\_\_

7

THE LONGEST TIME – SATB

8

What else would I do, I'm so in - spired — by you.  
That's where you found me, when you put your arms a - round me.

ah, ah,

ah, ah,

9

13

8

That has - n't hap-pened for the long - est time. Woh,  
I have - n't been there for the long - est time.

for the long - est time, Woh,

for the long - est time. Woh,

13

11

THE LONGEST TIME – SATB

8

for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est.

for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est.

for the long-est, for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est, for the long-est.

14

17

3. I'm that voice you're hear - ing in the hall,  
4. Who knows how much fur - ther we'll go on.

Oo, oo, Unis.

17

17

## THE LONGEST TIME – SATB

8 and the great - est mir - a - cle of all,  
May - be I'll be sor - ry when you're gone.

oo. Ah,

19

8 is how I need you and how you need - ed me, too.  
I'll take my chan - ces, I for - got how nice ro - mance is.

ah, ah, ah, ah,

21

8

That has - n't hap - pened for the long - est time.  
I have - n't been there for the long - est time.

for the long - est time.

for the long - est time.

23

25 End finger snaps

8

May - be had this won't last ver - y long, but  
I had sec - ond thoughts at the start. I

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

25

25

you feel so right, and I could be wrong.  
said to my - self hold on to your heart.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm wa oo - wah.

27

May - be I've know been hop - ing too hard, but  
Now I know the wo - man that you are, you're

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

29

To m. 17, (p. 5)

8

I've gone this far and it's more than I hoped for.  
won - der - ful so far and it's more than I hoped for.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah. More than I hoped for.  
Bm oo - wa oo - wah. More than I hoped for.

Bm oo - wa oo - wah, more. Bm bm bm

31

To m. 17, (p. 5)

33

 Opt. resume finger snaps

8

I don't care what consequence it brings. I have been a

Oo, oo, oo. Unis.

33

33



8

fool for less-er things. I want you so bad, I think you ought to know that

Ah, ah, ah,

ah, ah,

36

41

I in - tend to hold you for the long - est time. Woh,

for the long - est time. Woh,

for the long - est time. Woh,

41

39

THE LONGEST TIME – SATB

8

for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est

for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est

for the long-est, for the long-est time. Woh, for the long-est, for the long-est

42

End finger snaps  
*rit.*

time. Woh, for the long - est time.

*rit.*  
time. Woh, for the long - est time.

*rit.*  
time. Woh, for the long - est, for the long - est time.

45

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